

Redevelopment Commission Meeting September 18th 2025.

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5Mg6-kDOJ6k
Publication Date	2025-09-19T02:54:27Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Muncie Redevelopment Commission

Document: Official Meeting Transcript Analysis

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order, managing a lengthy agenda primarily focused on economic development, housing, and urban renewal in Muncie.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Bishop, Mr. Dale, Mr. Miller, Mr. Pilla, and Miss Waggley.
 - **Presenters & Staff:** Jeff (Administration/Redevelopment), Mayor Dan Ridenour (City of Muncie), John Mherren (Hall Property Group), Vicki Beach (Muncie Downtown Development Partnership), and Nate Howard (Muncie Land Bank).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The transcript begins mid-presentation regarding housing development aesthetics and does not explicitly record an invocation or Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The transcript does not explicitly record the motion or disposition for prior meeting minutes.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Item 1: 00:10:51 Housing Subdivision Funding Agreement (Steeplechase / Rigen Road Extension)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff (Administration) and the developer (Jeff/Builder representative).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board considered a \$47,200 funding match agreement with the Delaware County Redevelopment Commission to support infrastructure for a new residential subdivision off the Rigen Road extension. The project proposes 42 high-end or custom homes (with home prices targeted in the \$400k+ range, utilizing features like metal roofs, LVT flooring, and energy-efficient designs).
 - Mayor Dan Ridenour noted the land was originally acquired via Ball State University to encourage university staff to live locally.
 - Board members debated the equity of public investment (with local government subsidy calculated by a member at roughly 46% to 54% of development costs, totaling about \$1.9 million across entities including ARPA and EDIT funds).
 - Concerns were raised regarding public funds subsidizing high-end housing rather than core neighborhood revitalization or direct homebuyer assistance programs. Proponents argued the project addresses regional housing shortages, captures commuter wealth, generates \$20+ million in assessed value, and produces long-term tax and income revenue.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None during this specific item's formal hearing window.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via Roll Call Vote (Passed 3-2).
 - Ayes: Mr. Miller, Mr. Pilla, Miss Waggley.
 - Nays: Mr. Bishop, Mr. Dale.
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Item 2: 00:14:12 Muncie Mall Multi-Phase Redevelopment Agreement (Resolution 2025-06)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff (Administration) and John Mherren (Hall Property Group).

- **Deliberation Summary:** Hall Property Group presented a multi-phase redevelopment plan for the 50-acre Muncie Mall property, which currently suffers from 68% vacancy. Phase 1 involves a speculative \$2.5 million investment by the developer to demolish approximately 250,000 square feet of obsolete structures (including the former JCPenney, Sears, and theater buildings) to “flip the mall inside out” and create outward-facing retail parcels along McGalliard Road.
 - The agreement establishes a mall-specific tax increment financing (TIF) district utilizing a “pay-as-you-go” structure. The city/MRC reimburses verified demolition expenses strictly from the new tax increment generated, capping reimbursement at \$2,523,013 (with \$432,000 previously approved). The MRC retains 10% of the increment.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None during this specific item’s presentation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously, 5-0).
 - Ayes: Mr. Bishop, Mr. Dale, Mr. Miller, Mr. Pilla, Miss Waggle.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:25:54 Rick Yer (News Man and Author):** Expressed support for mall redevelopment investments. Criticized local government involvement in gated/luxury housing developments. Highlighted the blighted condition of Southway Plaza (noting a closed Dollar General and out-of-state ownership) and urged the city to utilize eminent domain or aggressive code enforcement.
 - **00:27:59 Tanya Saunders (Executive Director, Muncie Arts and Culture Council):** Provided community updates regarding public art integration, upcoming Exhibit Columbus installations (such as “Midnight Palace” in Dave’s Alley and a new public work at Ivy Tech on October 2nd), and invited commissioners to the Mayor’s Arts Awards at the Muncie Civic Theater.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Zain Bishop (Facade Grant Committee):** Reported that applications are under review and being processed according to guidelines.
 - **Vicki Beach (Muncie Downtown Development Partnership):** Reported strong occupancy rates (90th percentile) and high attendance at 2025 signature events (Arts Walk, Fire Up Downtown). Previewed upcoming October 2nd Arts Walk attractions, including “Echoes of the Past” AR/QR historical site overlays and pedestrian iron works utility covers.
 - **Nate Howard (Muncie Land Bank):** Provided updates on property transactions in the Old West End, side-lot transfers, and upcoming public housing/rental market

presentations for first-Friday meetings.

- **Board Logistics Complaint:** Mr. Bishop voiced strong dissatisfaction with receiving complex agenda materials only 1.5 days prior to the meeting, requesting a minimum 4-day review window for major financial proposals.
 - **Adjournment:** Officially adjourned until the next regular meeting scheduled for **October 16th 01:33:15**.
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